

University of Victoria Impact+ Postdoctoral Fellowship in Evolutionary Genomics

The Owens Lab at the University of Victoria is looking for a candidate to apply for a Canada Impact+ Postdoctoral Fellowship. The proposed project will focus on evolutionary epigenomics of aging in rockfish. The chosen candidate will be sponsored by the Owens Lab to apply for the Canada Impact+ Postdoctoral Fellowship with employment contingent on a successful application. Due to program requirements, the applicant must be currently residing outside of Canada. The application is minimal and will require only a small amount of writing from the applicant. A successful applicant will start the position between September 2026 and March 2027.

Project Description:

Rockfish species have exceptional variation in maximum lifespan, from 16 years to 200 years. To understand how differences in maximum lifespan evolve, we have generated a dataset of whole genome methyl-sequencing for 200+ rockfish samples of known age from four separate species. The candidate will use this data to answer of how age-specific methylation patterns vary between species with vastly differently lifespans, and what role this plays in the aging process. Additionally, the candidate will help develop a nanopore sequencing based epigenetic clock for rockfish.

Required Qualifications:

A Ph.D. degree (completed by the time of appointment) in Biology, Evolutionary Biology, Genomics, Bioinformatics or related disciplines. Expertise in genomics or epigenomics is ideal.

Currently residing outside of Canada.

Technical skills suggested:

R, Python or Unix skills, experience with large genomic or epigenomics datasets.

Application start date: Apr 23, 2026

Application close date: May 17, 2026

Position Length: Two years, pending annual review

Salary: \$70,000

Applicants must submit:

- A CV, including the e-mail and phone number for three references;
- A short paragraph explaining the applicant's experience with genomics and/or evolutionary biology;
- Links to or reprints of 1 published paper led by the author demonstrating their expertise;

Equity and diversity are essential for academic excellence. An open and diverse community fosters the inclusion of voices that have been underrepresented or discouraged. We encourage applications from members of groups that have been marginalized on any grounds enumerated under the B.C. Human Rights Code, including sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, racialization, disability, political belief, religion, marital or family status, age, and/or status as a First Nations, Metis, Inuit, or Indigenous person.

Submit applications to:

Greg Owens (grego@uvic.ca)